The next territory that the Islamic terrorist organizations set their sights on was Iraq, which had been torn between the Shiites and the Sunnis after the US occupation. The Arab Spring was a dream come true for the radical Islamic terrorist groups. In Egypt, the Muslim Brotherhood came to power for the first time since their inception in the 1920s. In Tunisia, Ghannouchi, who established the Islamist *Ennahdha* party and was a political exile in England for decades, is currently in power. Syria has descended into an era of extreme instability that has involved almost the whole world. The Sunni territory that connects Iraq and Syria has become the cradle of ISIS, which is an offshoot of al-Qaeda. Today (2018), when we can assess that ISIS's presence in Syria and Iraq is declining, we can also identify the next area from which al-Qaeda and ISIS will seek to base themselves, and that is Africa. From North Africa to sub-Saharan Africa, these groups are establishing themselves all over the continent, beginning in Libya and going all the way down to South Africa.

The conflict between al-Qaeda and Israel is only about a decade old. Al-Qaeda's hostility toward Israel has nothing to do with any provocation on Israel's part but has its roots in radical Islamic ideology, according to which Jews have no right to exist and their elimination is a religious obligation. In some of his earlier remarks, bin Laden mentioned Israel as being only his third priority. In one of his speeches, he called Israel "a miserable polity," indicating that it was of no real importance. In an interview he gave a few years before the 9/11 attacks, he even said that if the Americans were to leave Saudi Arabia, he would be willing to sign a peace agreement with Israel!

The first real connections between bin Laden and Palestinian terrorists, members of Islamic Jihad and Hamas, were apparently established while he was living in Sudan during the first half of the 1990s; Palestinian terrorists found their way to al-Qaeda's training camps in Afghanistan. Some of them returned to Israel with the mission of setting up secret al-Qaeda cells. However, this did not lead to any real terrorist activity until the 2002 Mombasa attack on an Israeli-owned hotel and the attempted firing of missiles at an Israeli plane that had just taken off from Mombasa. The Mombasa attacks were a historic milestone in Israel's struggle against terrorism. In general, Israel's war on terror had been limited to the borders of the Middle East. It had occasionally extended to other places in the world, but only for specific one-time missions. The attacks in Mombasa